



Medford City Council
Medford, Massachusetts

MEETING DATE

August 4, 2026

SPONSORED BY

Emily Lazzaro, Council Vice
President

AGENDA ITEM

26-135 - Resolution in Remembrance of John Westwater

FULL TEXT AND DESCRIPTION

Whereas, John Westwater lived on Usher Road, steps from the West Medford train station. He taught middle school at St. Joseph's in Medford for many years, where his affectionate nickname was "Mister Sister." His favorite hobbies were camping and going for walks. He loved nature, his home, and his neighborhood; and,

Whereas, on July 20th an Amtrak train was passing through the West Medford train station, just down the street from where John lived. He was crossing the tracks and was hit. John died from his injuries. He was 77 years old; now, therefore:

Be It Resolved by the Medford City Council that we share our deepest condolences with Mr. Westwater's family and loved ones and express our hope that this senseless tragedy will not be in vain and will not be repeated.

Be it Further Resolved that we will work with the Massachusetts Bay Transit Authority and Amtrak, a quasi-governmental corporation created by Congress in 1970 to preserve intercity passenger rail service, to make sorely needed safety improvements to the West Medford commuter and Amtrak train station so this will never happen again.

RECOMMENDATION

FISCAL IMPACT

ATTACHMENTS

None